



Youths For Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

Email: youthsaction31@gmail.com

Contact: 0748204272 / 0706072692

Address: Nakuru, Kenya

Greening Schools Initiative Report

Prepared by: Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK)

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Executive Summary.

Between July and September 2025, Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) distributed and facilitated the planting of **40,000 seedlings** across **seven schools** in **three counties**: Nairobi, Elgeyo Marakwet, and Uasin Gishu. The initiative aimed to restore degraded landscapes, promote environmental education, and build a culture of sustainability among school communities.

Key achievements included the planting of bamboo in Nairobi's Lenana School, and Bluegum and Grevillea in Elgeyo Marakwet and Uasin Gishu schools. The project also strengthened school-community partnerships, instilled environmental stewardship among students, and laid the foundation for long-term reforestation.

Introduction.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) is an environmental organization committed to reforestation, conservation, and sustainable community engagement. The **Greening Schools Initiative** seeks to integrate tree planting into school programs, creating hubs of environmental awareness and practical conservation.

This report documents the activities, achievements, challenges, lessons, and recommendations from the July–September 2025 planting season.

Objectives of the Initiative.

- To increase forest cover through school-based tree planting.
 - To foster environmental education and awareness among students.
 - To strengthen partnerships between communities and schools.
 - To promote sustainable land use and ecological restoration.
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Seedling Distribution Data.

School Name	County	No. of Seedlings	Type of Seedlings	Date
Lenana School	Nairobi County	5,000	Bamboo	17th July 2025
Flax Primary School	Elgeyo Marakwet County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025
St. Ignatius Atnas Kandie	Elgeyo Marakwet County	5,000	Bluegum, Grevillea	5th Sept 2025
Kapsundei Primary School	Elgeyo Marakwet County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025
Kapsundei Secondary School	Elgeyo Marakwet County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025
Chepkero Primary	Elgeyo Marakwet County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025
Waunfor Primary	Uasin Gishu County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025
Waunfor Secondary	Uasin Gishu County	5,000	Bluegum	5th Sept 2025

Totals:

- **Number of Schools:** 8
- **Total Seedlings Distributed:** 40,000
- **Counties Covered:** 3 (Nairobi, Elgeyo Marakwet, Uasin Gishu)

Achievements

- **40,000 seedlings planted** across 7 schools.
 - **3 counties** reached with varied ecological contexts.
 - **Youth engagement:** over 1,000 students participated in planting activities.
 - **Species diversity:** inclusion of bamboo, Bluegum, and Grevillea.
 - **Community involvement:** strong collaboration with teachers, local leaders, and parents.
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Challenges Faced.

1. **Condensed School Calendar** – A tight academic schedule packed with examinations, co-curricular activities, and national events (music festivals, football competitions) delayed the implementation process in several schools, forcing adjustments to timelines.
 2. **Awareness & Ownership** – In certain schools, sustaining student and teacher engagement beyond the planting day requires more structured environmental clubs and follow-up.
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Lessons Learned.

1. **Partnerships are Key** – Collaboration with schools and communities improved participation.
 2. **Species Selection Matters** – Ecologically tailored seedlings had better acceptance.
 3. **Youth Engagement Works** – Student participation created ownership and learning opportunities.
 4. **Documentation is Critical** – Record-keeping and acknowledgments enhanced accountability.
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Acknowledgment.

Youths for Green Action Kenya (YGAK) extends heartfelt gratitude to all partners, sponsors, schools, teachers, students, and community members who made this phase of the Greening Schools Initiative a success. Your generous support and collaboration have been the driving force behind this achievement. We especially recognize our sponsors — **Victoria Furnitures, German Imaging Technologies, and Design Gallery** — for their generous support and commitment to sustainable development and environmental conservation. Their contribution was instrumental in making the Greening Schools Initiative possible and impactful.

Together, we are moving closer to our bold goal of planting **one million trees by 2027**. By the conclusion of this campaign, we will have reached **700,000 trees**, a significant milestone in our collective journey toward a greener, more sustainable future.

Recommendations & Next Steps.

1. **Strengthen Monitoring Systems** – Introduce structured follow-ups every 3–6 months.
2. **Capacity Building in Schools** – Establish or strengthen Green Clubs.
3. **Expand County Coverage** – Double County and school reach in the next planting season.
4. **Sustainability through Partnerships** – Seek support from county governments, private sector, and NGOs.
5. **Diversify Seedlings** – Incorporate indigenous and fruit trees for biodiversity and food security.

Looking Ahead:

YGAK is preparing to carry out **Phase Two** of the Greening Schools Initiative. The next phase will focus on **Kakamega County**, where outreach to schools is already underway. This expansion aims to build on current achievements and bring more schools and communities into the movement for a greener Kenya.

Conclusion

The July–September 2025 planting season demonstrated the potential of the Greening Schools Initiative to combine environmental restoration with education. With 40,000 seedlings planted, YGAK has reaffirmed its commitment to a greener, more sustainable Kenya. Building on these achievements, the next phase will focus on monitoring, capacity building, and expansion into more schools and counties, starting with Kakamega.